

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

DOW JONES | News Corp *****

TUESDAY, MARCH 25, 2025 ~ VOL. CCLXXXV NO. 69

WSJ.com

★★★★ \$5.00

DJIA 42583.32 ▲ 597.97 1.42% NASDAQ 18188.59 ▲ 2.3% STOXX 600 548.93 ▼ 0.1% 10-YR. TREAS. ▼ 21/32, yield 4.330% OIL \$69.11 ▲ \$0.83 GOLD \$3,013.10 ▼ \$5.10 EURO \$1.0802 YEN 150.70

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Boeing sought to** withdraw an agreement to plead guilty in a long-running criminal case that blamed the company for deceiving regulators before two deadly crashes of 737 MAX jets. **A1**

◆ **23andMe, the DNA** testing service whose genotype reports permit clients to trace their ancestry, filed for bankruptcy and announced the resignation of its chief executive, Anne Wojcicki. **A1**

◆ **U.S. stocks began** the week on an upbeat note, with the S&P 500, Nasdaq and Dow industrials gaining 1.8%, 2.3% and 1.4%, respectively. **B1**

◆ **Chinese automaker BYD** said its revenue last year increased to the equivalent of \$107 billion, exceeding Tesla's revenue of \$97.7 billion for the year. **B1**

◆ **Dun & Bradstreet agreed** to be acquired by private-equity firm Clearlake in a transaction valued at \$7.7 billion, including outstanding debt. **B1**

◆ **United is revamping** its credit cards with JPMorgan Chase, raising fees but adding benefits the airline said will make the cards more valuable. **B1**

◆ **The World Economic Forum** is shaking up its leadership ranks in the wake of a board investigation into the workplace culture of the Davos conference organizer. **B3**

◆ **Bayer shares fell** sharply after the company was ordered to pay \$2.1 billion by a jury in a Georgia state court in connection with a case about its Roundup weedkiller. **B3**

◆ **SAP claimed the top spot** as Europe's largest company by market value, dethroning Denmark's Novo Nordisk. **B4**

World-Wide

◆ **Senior national-security** officials discussed highly classified U.S. plans to launch airstrikes against Yemen's Houthi militants using a nongovernment messaging app and mistakenly included a journalist in the conversation. **A1**

◆ **Trump said he** might soften the reciprocal tariffs he plans to impose on U.S. trading partners next month, and that some nations might be exempt. **A2**

◆ **The Justice Department** asked the Supreme Court to block a judge's order requiring it to reinstate more than 16,000 federal employees dismissed as part of the Trump administration's plan to shrink government. **A4**

◆ **Two judges said** people deported by the Trump administration weren't given a meaningful chance to challenge their designations as gang members before they were whisked to a notorious prison in El Salvador. **A4**

◆ **Trump nominated** Susan Monarez to lead the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, elevating her from role of acting director of the agency. **A5**

◆ **Postmaster General** Louis DeJoy stepped down from the job, pre-empting a decision by Trump to force him out of the position faster than planned. **A3**

◆ **Cuts to Social Security's** staff and services are raising fears of an erosion of confidence in a nearly 90-year-old program that benefits some 70 million people. **A4**

◆ **Died: Mia Love, 49,** first Black woman to be elected to Congress as a Republican. **A5**

CONTENTS		Markets.....	B9
Arts in Review.....	A13	Opinion.....	A15-17
Business&Finance	B2,B5	Personal Journal	A11-12
Business News.....	B3	Sports.....	A14
Crossword.....	A13	Technology.....	B4
Heard on Street.....	B10	U.S. News.....	A2-6
Market Data.....	B7	World News	A8-9,A18



© 2025 Dow Jones & Company, Inc. All Rights Reserved

U.S. Resumes Deportation Flights to Venezuela



BLOMBERG NEWS

EXPELLED: People deported from the U.S. arrived at the Caracas airport early Monday after the U.S. and Venezuela reached an agreement on the flights. Separately, two judges on Monday said that people accused of being part of a Venezuelan gang and deported to a prison in El Salvador weren't given a meaningful chance to challenge their designations as gang members. **A4**

Barriers to Global Trade Rise At a Pace Not Seen in Decades

By JASON DOUGLAS
AND TOM FAIRLESS

Barriers to open trade are rising across the world at a pace unseen in decades, a cascade of protectionism that harks back to the isolationist fervor that swept the globe in the 1930s and worsened the Great Depression.

It isn't just President Trump's extensive tariffs, which set off retaliatory measures across Europe, China and Canada targeting hun-

dreds of U.S. goods. Even before Trump retook the White House, many countries were increasing trade barriers, often against China, as they tried to beat back a flood of electric cars, steel and other goods pressuring their home-grown industries.

Now those efforts are proliferating as countries brace for a new wave of goods redirected across the globe by the U.S.'s rising tariff shield. The European Union said last week it plans to toughen measures to

protect its steel and aluminum producers from imports diverted from the U.S. by Trump's 25% tariffs on those two metals. And on Monday, Trump said during a cabinet meeting that the U.S. will announce automotive tariffs "very shortly," and will unveil pharmaceutical tariffs "at some point." But later Trump said in the Oval Office that he "may give a lot of countries breaks."

Economists and historians said the flurry of recent moves suggest the world

could be heading toward the largest, broadest surge in protectionist activity since the U.S. Smoot-Hawley Tariff Act of 1930 touched off a global retreat behind tariff walls that lasted until after World War II. Economists don't think the

Please turn to page A2

◆ **Trump looks to soften reciprocal levies.....** **A2**
◆ **Stock markets rally on tariff shift.....** **B1**
◆ **Heard on the Street: Tariffs threaten Ford dividend...** **B10**

Universities Push To Appease Trump

Under attack, schools are quietly trying to make friends in Washington

By MAGGIE SEVERNS

WASHINGTON—When University of Michigan President Santa Ono sat down for breakfast earlier this month with a group of lawmakers from his home state, the message was clear: The school was ready to play ball with Trump's Washington.

It was time for universities to "wake up" and start addressing the reasons why they have lost so much trust, Ono told the bipartisan group in a hotel conference room near the Capitol, according to people with knowledge of the meeting.

Ono added that universities should listen to their most "vocal critics."

University leaders, pinned between liberal faculty and the Trump administration, are quietly trying to make friends in Washington amid widespread concerns about research budgets, student aid and the White House's quest to push academia to the right.

During the election campaign, President Trump vowed "to reclaim our once

Please turn to page A10

◆ **Columbia's president faces angry faculty.....** **A10**

These People Found Fame And Money—on LinkedIn

* * *

Site becomes a path to stardom for workers who mix the personal and the professional

By ANN-MARIE ALCÁNTARA

April Little's rise to internet stardom began three years ago with a post about layoffs and recruitment services.

People who lose their jobs in high-profile cuts, she wrote, often get showered with offers for help at the expense of millions of others who have been out of work for longer. "Do they need a big event or company tied to them to get recognition?" she asked.

A post like this might have garnered a few likes on Instagram or TikTok before quickly disappearing into the ether. But on LinkedIn, it's the kind of frank talk that can turn you into a celebrity.

Little soon had 100,000 followers on the site, and her fan

base continued to swell. "I don't see myself as a content creator, even though I am," said Little. She earned \$150,000 in the past two years, as companies look to reach her 260,000 followers.

The 38-year-old human-resources executive in Rochester, N.Y., is among thousands who have forged a path to low-level fame and fortune by injecting some personality into a site that is typically all business. She and others have used their popularity to build their brands, find clients and sign sponsorship deals.

At its core, LinkedIn is a résumé site. For years, the most common posts were congratulations for new jobs and work anniversaries. But in the past

Please turn to page A12

INSIDE



PERSONAL JOURNAL
Healthcare in the U.S. frustrates both sides—but physicians hope to fix growing divide. **A11**

BUSINESS & FINANCE
Chinese automaker BYD beats Tesla to \$100 billion in annual revenue. **B1**

23andMe Tumbles Into Bankruptcy, CEO Steps Down

By ROLFE WINKLER
AND KIMBERLEY KAO

23andMe, the buzzy consumer technology startup that convinced millions of people to spit into test tubes to determine their ancestry, filed for bankruptcy late Sunday night and announced the resignation of its chief executive.

Shares dropped 59% Monday after the late Sunday bankruptcy filing. It marks a stunning fall for a health-technology company that more than 15 million consumers have used to gain new insight into their lineage and health risks.

CEO Anne Wojcicki, who is stepping down from her posi-

tion but remaining on the board, has so far tried unsuccessfully to rescue the business by buying it back.

Wojcicki wrote in a late Sunday post on X that she still aims to buy the company's assets. "I remain committed to our long-term vision of being a global leader in genetics and establishing genetics as a fundamental part of healthcare ecosystems worldwide," she wrote.

23andMe traded at \$0.73 per share late Monday, the second time its stock has fallen below \$1. The company did a reverse 20:1 share split in October to boost its price above

Please turn to page A6

Top U.S. Officials Discussed Plans For War in Unclassified Group Chat

Senior Trump administration national-security officials held detailed discussions of highly classified U.S. plans to launch airstrikes against Ye-

By Michael R. Gordon,
Nancy A. Youssef
and Alexander Ward

men's Houthi militants using a nongovernment messaging app and mistakenly included a journalist in the conversation, U.S. officials said Monday.

The chats over the encrypted Signal app spanned days and included specific information about weapons, targets and timing used in the attack, according to the Atlantic magazine, whose editor, Jeffrey Goldberg, was inadvertently included in the discussion and who disclosed the texts.

National-security experts and former officials said that



Defense chief Pete Hegseth

use of Signal for conducting classified discussions about imminent military action was a serious breach of security procedures governing the handling of sensitive defense information. It also opened a window

into policy differences within the administration before the strikes on March 15.

Vice President JD Vance was skeptical of the need to strike the Houthis. Little U.S. trade passed through the Suez Canal connecting the Red Sea to the Mediterranean, whereas "40 percent of European trade does," he said.

Attacking the militants, Vance argued, would benefit Europe far more than the U.S. and might lead to a spike in oil prices. "I am not sure the president is aware how inconsistent this is with his message on Europe right now," he said. While he would support the consensus of the top officials in the chat, Vance said, "I just hate bailing Europe out again."

Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth and an account belonging to "S.M.," apparently the ini-

Please turn to page A4